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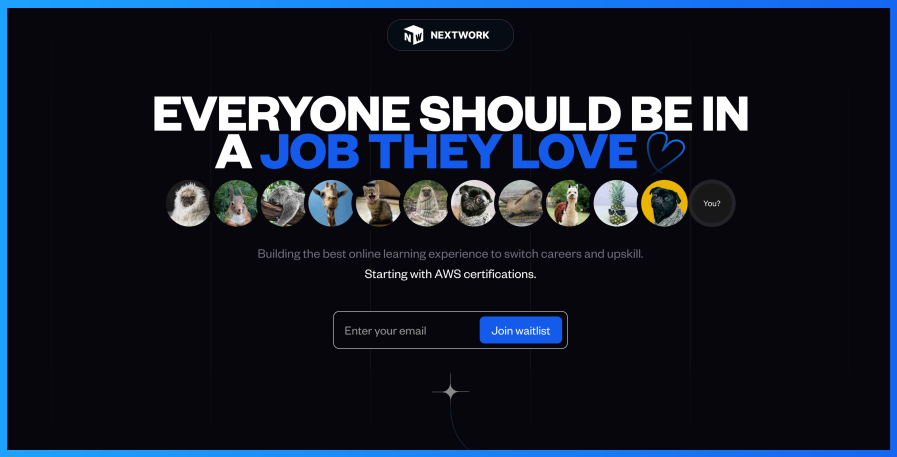
Host a Website on Amazon S3

James Paonessa



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Introducing Today's Project!

What is Amazon S3

Amazon S3 is a wonderful, simple method of maintaining a collection of files for use in a variety of applications; data storage or website management.

How I used Amazon S3 in this project

Today we setup a S3 bucket and utilized it to host a simple website.

One thing I didn't expect in this project was...

Learning to methods of controling acces to the sites files showed me the unique challenges of how managing the ACI/permissions of these files can have a drastic change on its functionality.

This project took me...

This project took roughly 20 minutes from start to finish. While a particularly challenging project, I took extra time to explore the various modules to get more acquainted with its setup. I found it similar in setup of other website hosting setups.

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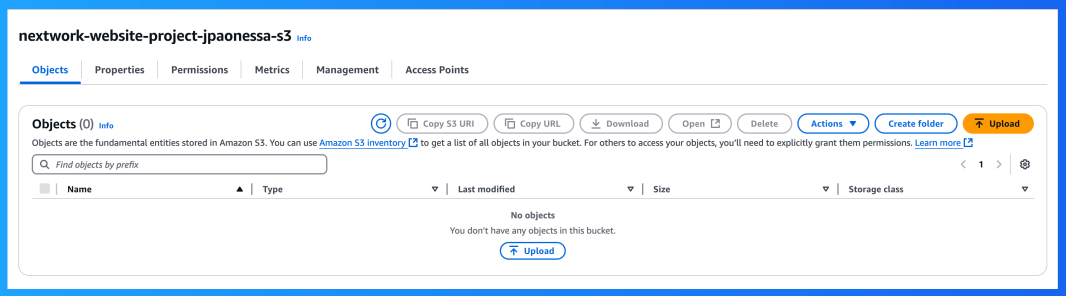
How I Set Up an S3 Bucket

Creating an S3 bucket took me but a few moments but I can see where creating templates for these task can ensure quick and accurate spin-ups of various projects for repeated tasks.

The Region I picked for my S3 bucket was US West, N.California because that region is closest to me and will offer me the lowest latency and similar to the companies I would work for.

S3 bucket names are globally unique! This means that every bucket created within S3 will always have a unique name. This means that while I have a unique name, I should not share it with others unless I need to.



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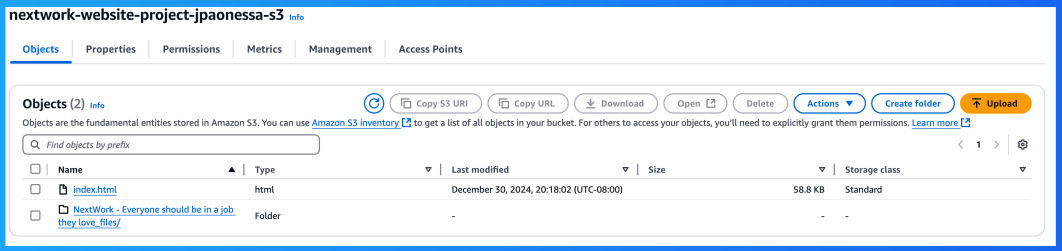
Upload Website Files to S3

index.html and image assets

I uploaded two files to my S3 bucket - they were an html file; index.html and a zip archive; NextWork - Everyone should be in a job they love_files.

Both files are necessary for this project as one provides the html files for the website and the other contains the image files necessary.



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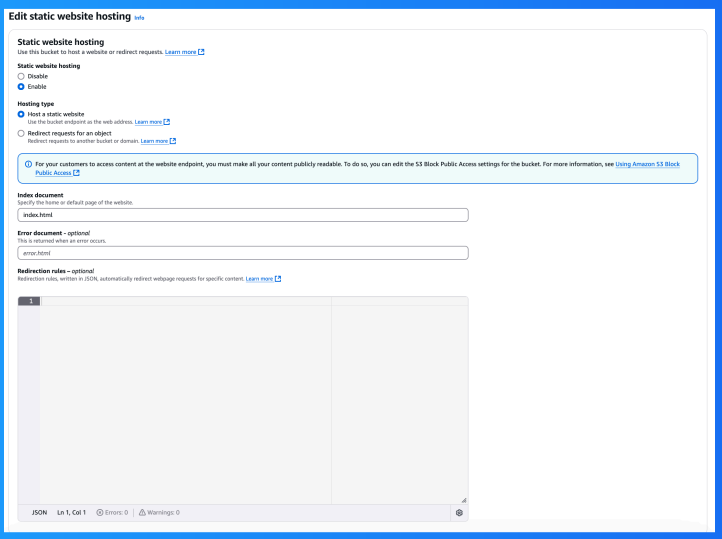
Static Website Hosting on S3

Website hosting means that the S3 bucket has been setup to read the files contained (HTML/images) and use this code to showcase a static website for people who visit the designated site.

To enable website hosting with my S3 bucket, I navigated to the "Static website hosting" section within the S3 bucket setup. After enabling, I was taken to a setup page which I was able to designate the base HTML read and what 404/error site used.

An ACL is a system for designating who (users) can do what and what files can be accessed. I enabled access for ACLs within this project.



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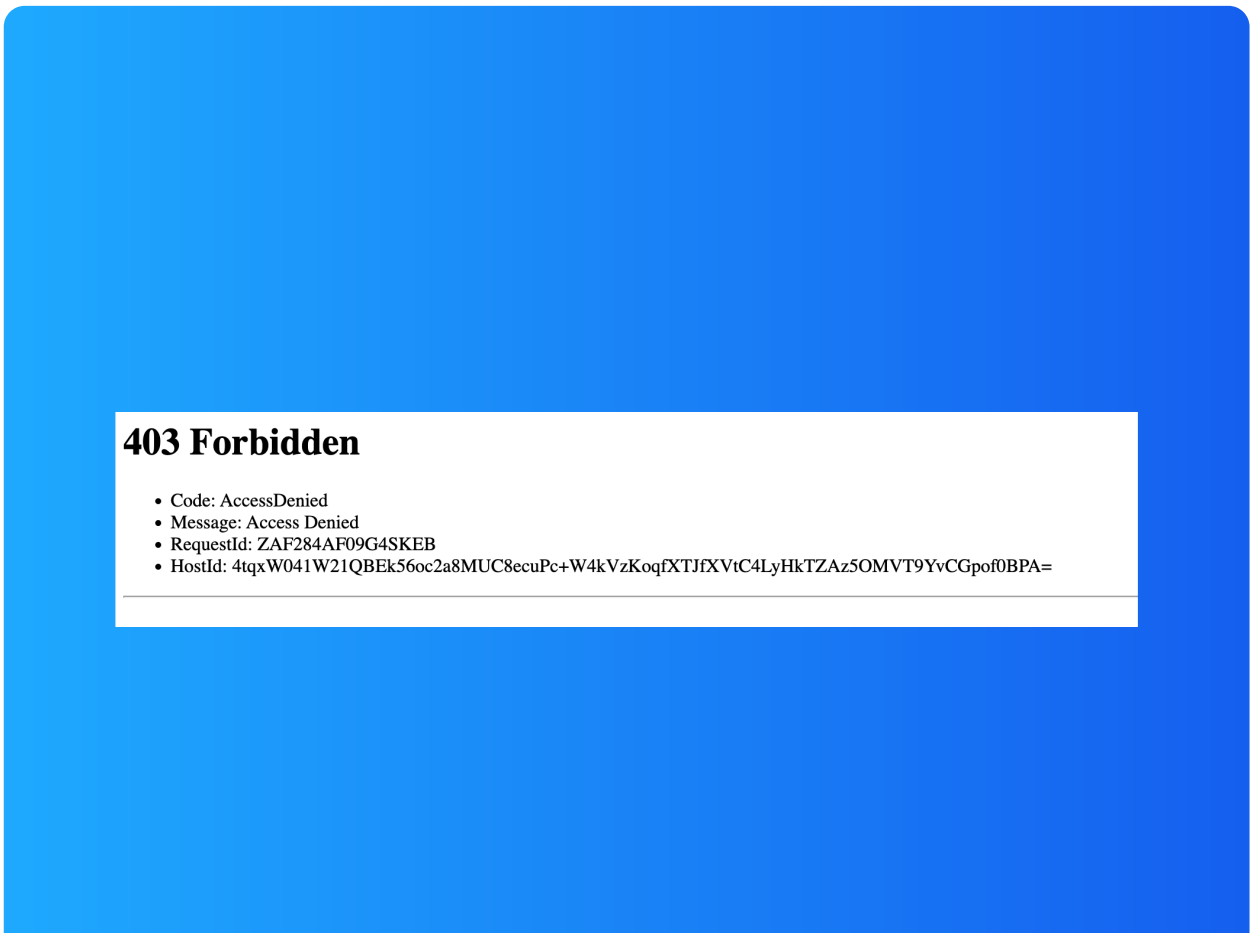
Bucket Endpoints

Once a static website is enabled, S3 produces a bucket endpoint URL, which is the unique referenced endpoint within the AWS S3 system. This URL name is unique to me and my S3 bucket.

When I first visited the bucket endpoint URL, I saw a 403 - Access Denied message. The reason for this error was that I had not finished setting the permissions for the files inside the bucket. The index.html is still set as private in its ACL.



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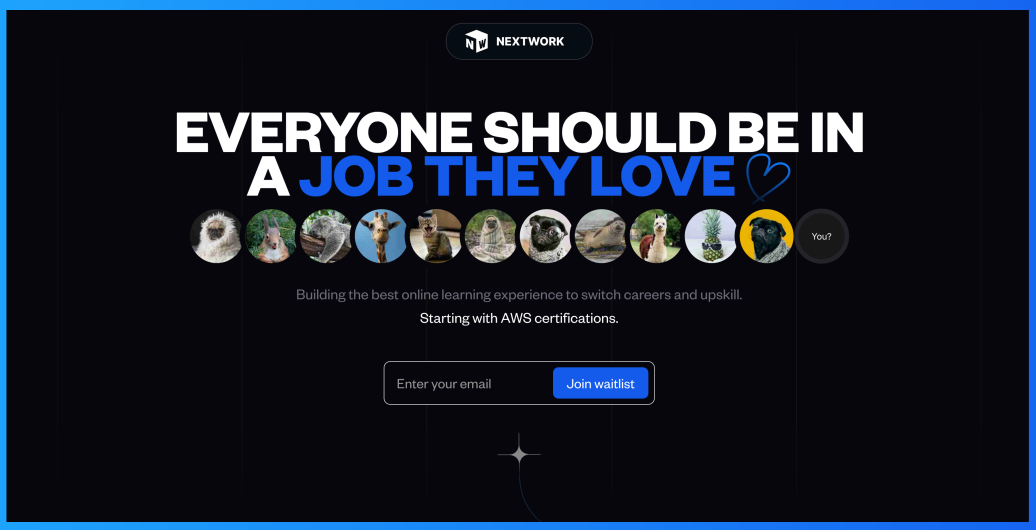
Success!

To resolve this connection error, I had to also grant public access using ACL to the folder containing the supporting files. This was the uploaded folder, NextWork - Everyone should be in a job they love_files.